



Kanban

User Manual

App version 0.6.1 · July 2026

Welcome! This guide covers everything you can do in Sabeel Kanban — from finding your first board to running boards and approving accounts. It is organized by role: **everyone** starts with Part 1; **managers** add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick “How do I...?” index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (<https://sabeel-institute-kanban.web.app>) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. It is **phone-first**: the mobile layout is its own thing, not a squeezed desktop board. Throughout this guide, where the phone and browser layouts differ, you’ll see them side by side.

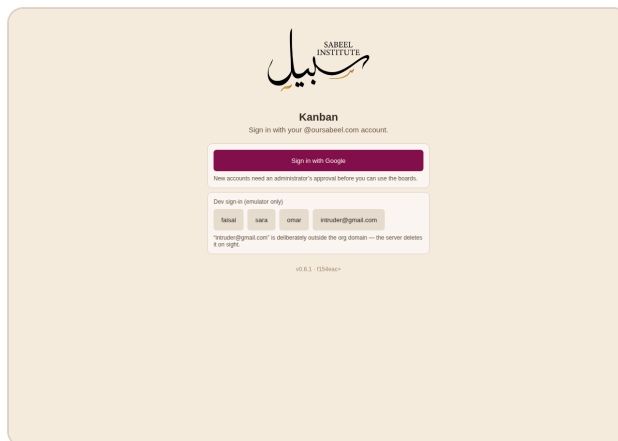
The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **Work lives on boards.** A board is a set of **columns** (like *To Do* → *In Progress* → *Done*) holding **cards**. Each card is one piece of work.
2. **You see the boards you’ve been added to.** Managers can see and join every board and create new ones; members see only theirs.
3. **A card carries everything about a task** — a description, a priority, a due date, the people assigned, labels, and a comment thread. Open it to see or change any of that in one place.
4. **Everything is live and shared.** Move a card and everyone watching sees it move. **My Work** gathers every card assigned to you, across every board, so you never have to go board-hunting to find what’s yours.

That’s the whole system. Everything below is detail.

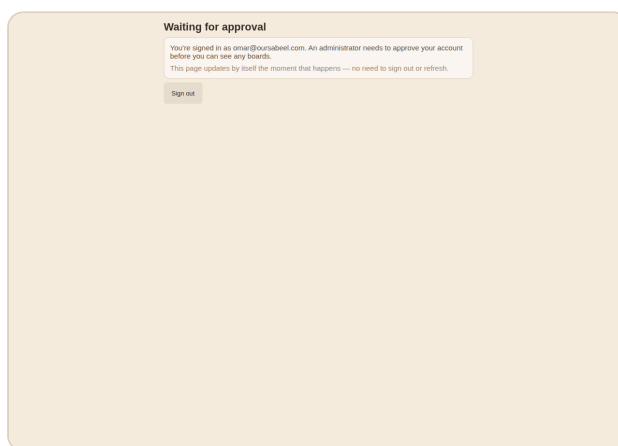
Part 1 — For everyone

1.1 Signing in



Open the app or website and tap **Sign in with Google**. Sign-in is restricted to your **@oursabeel.com** account — no other account works, and there is no password to remember.

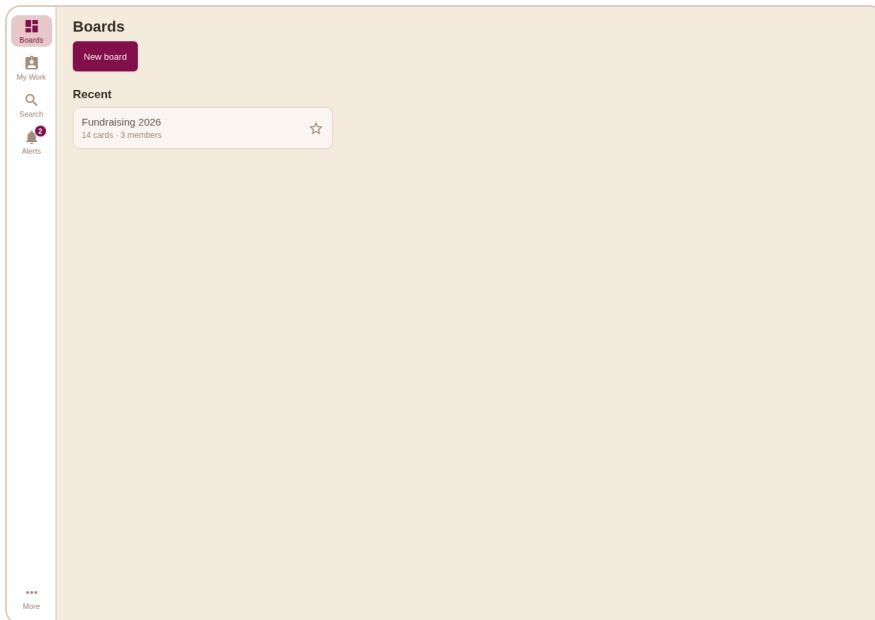
First time? You'll wait for approval



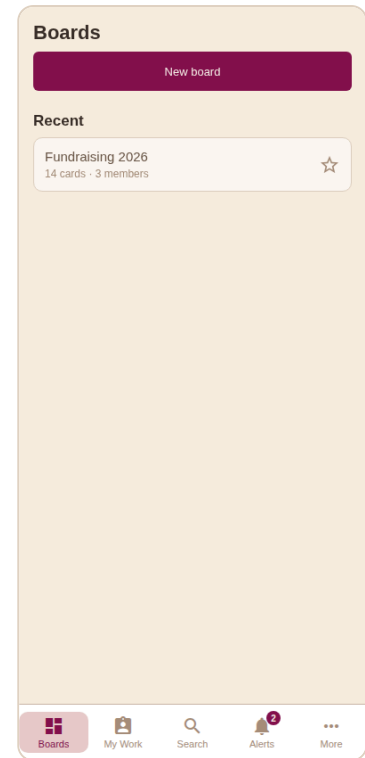
New accounts land on a **“Waiting for approval”** screen. An administrator has to approve your account before you can see any boards — this is deliberate, and it takes them one tap. Leave the page open: it lets you in by itself the moment they approve you, with no need to sign out or refresh. If you seem stuck here, contact your admin.

1.2 Finding your way around

A slim navigation bar is always in reach — **along the bottom on a phone**, and **down the left side in a browser**. It carries the places you move between:



In a browser — a rail down the left



On a phone — a bar along the bottom

- **Boards** — your board list, the home screen.
- **My Work** — every card assigned to you, across every board.
- **Search** — find a card by its words.
- **Alerts** — what you’ve been told about; a badge shows how many are unread.
- **More** — everything that isn’t a place you go often: **Stats** (managers and admins), **People** (admins), and **Sign out**. It also shows the version of the app you’re running, which is the first thing to quote if something looks wrong.

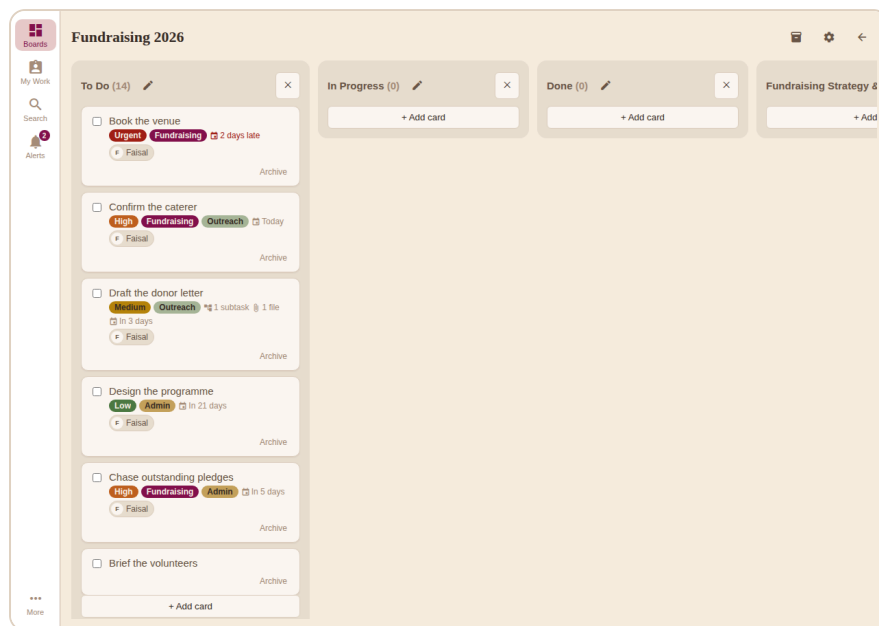
Open a board or a card and the phone’s bottom bar steps aside, giving the board the whole screen; it returns when you go back to a list. In a browser the left rail stays put — it’s narrow enough to keep out of the way.

1.3 Your boards

Boards lists everything you can open. Tap the **star** beside a board to keep it at the top; boards you’ve opened recently follow, then the rest alphabetically.

Every board shows as a card in a grid on wide screens, and as a single-column list on a phone. Managers create boards with **New board** (see Part 2).

1.4 Inside a board



In a browser — every column at once



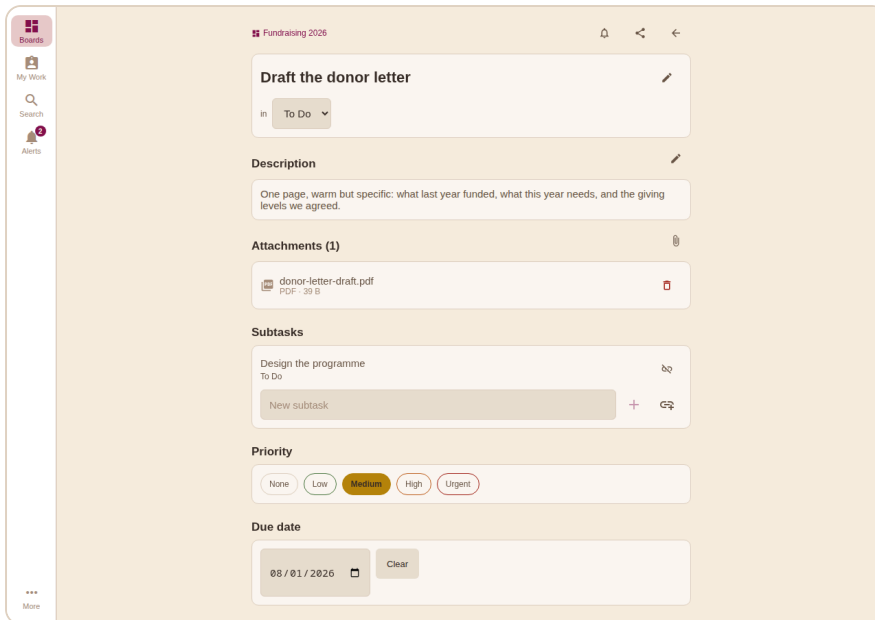
*On a phone — one column, swipe
between*

A board is columns of cards. **In a browser** you see every column at once. **On a phone** one column fills the screen — swipe left and right to move between them, and the header tells you where you are (“In Progress, 2 of 4”).

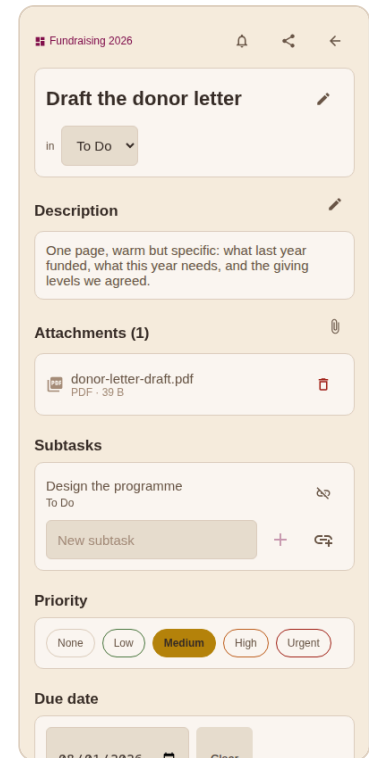
Each card shows, at a glance: its **title**, a **priority badge**, its **labels**, its **due date** (red if overdue), and the **people assigned** (as name chips) — so you can read a card without opening it. A card with no priority set shows no badge. Tap **+ Add card** at the bottom of a column, type a title, press Enter — that’s a new card.

1.5 Working with a card

Tap any card to open the full view.



In a browser



On a phone

- **Title** — shown in full as the card's heading, however long it is. Tap the **pencil** to edit it, then **Save**.
- **Column** — a dropdown showing where the card sits. Change it to move the card without leaving it.
- **Description** — plain text. Type whatever you like; it appears to everyone exactly as you typed it. **Save** to keep it, **Cancel** to discard.
- **Attachments** — files on the card. See below. A card with files shows a small **paperclip and count** on the board, so you can see which cards carry something without opening them.
- **Subtasks** — see below.
- **Priority** — none / low / medium / high / urgent, shown as a coloured **badge** on the card face (e.g. *Urgent*); *none* shows no badge.
- **Due date** — a whole day, not a time. Pick it from a calendar; **Clear** removes it. An overdue card shows in red and says *Overdue*.
- **Assignees** — anyone on the board. Tap the **add-person** icon beside the *Assignees* heading, then pick a name; the **remove-person** icon on a row unassigns them. They show as **name chips** on the card face, the card lands in each person's **My Work**, and they're notified.
- **Labels** — a short vocabulary shared by **every** board, shown as coloured **badges** on the card face. Press **+** to add one to the shared set and this card at once.

- **Comments** — discuss the work. Type **@** to pull someone in; they're notified. A list of everyone on the board appears above the box — **anyone assigned to the card comes first**, and it scrolls if the board is large. Keep typing to narrow it, or tap a name. On a computer you can stay on the keyboard: **↑/↓** to move, **Enter** or **Tab** to pick, **Esc** to dismiss.

The list closes when you click away, and picking a name never loses your place in the box. -

Subscribe — the **bell** in the card's header. Tap it to hear about new comments on a card even when it isn't assigned to you; tap again to stop. It turns solid while you're subscribed. Subscribing is about the *conversation* — nothing else on the card notifies you. A card assigned to you already sends you its comments, but subscribing as well means you keep hearing about it if you're later unassigned.

You can edit your own comment with the **pencil**, and the **@** works there too — mention someone in an edit and they're told, once. Correcting the wording afterwards doesn't notify anyone again. -

Activity — who changed what, and when, including subtasks being linked and unlinked. Written by the system, so no one can edit it.

Ordinary actions — move, archive, assign, delete — are **icons**, not big buttons, so a card stays compact. Each icon has a label for screen readers.

Attachments — putting files on a card

Tap the **paperclip** beside the *Attachments* heading.

On a computer that opens your file browser. **On a phone** you're asked where from: **Choose a file**, **Photo library**, or **Take a photo** — so a receipt or a whiteboard can go straight onto the card without saving it anywhere first.

- **Up to 10 MB per file**, any type, as many as you like on one card.
- Each file shows its **name, kind and size**. Tap it to **open it** — a PDF in your PDF reader, a photo in your gallery, everything else in whatever app you normally use for it.
- The **bin icon** removes a file. **Anyone on the board can remove any file**, not just whoever added it — attaching the wrong thing is an easy mistake and shouldn't need chasing someone else. It asks first, and it cannot be undone.
- Attaching and removing both appear in **Activity**, with who did it.

While a file is uploading you'll see a progress bar. If it doesn't finish — you lost signal, or closed the app — the file simply isn't added; nothing half-made is left on the card.

Files live with the card. Move the card to another board and they go too; archiving a card keeps them. Deleting a card permanently deletes its files.

Finding an archived card

Archiving takes a card off the board but **keeps it**. The board header has an **archive icon** — open it to see everything archived on that board, **most recently archived first**, and **Restore to the board** puts a card back. Anyone who can archive can restore; permanent deletion stays with managers and admins.

If the column a card came from has since been deleted, it comes back in the **first column** and says so — rather than refusing to come back at all.

Subtasks — breaking a card down

A card can be broken into **subtasks**, which are simply other cards on the same board, linked to it.

- Type a title under **Subtasks** and tap **+** to create one. It's made in the same column as the card you're on.
- The **link icon** beside it attaches a card that's already on the board. There's a filter box, because a board can hold a lot of cards.
- Tap any subtask to **jump straight to it**; it opens like any other card, with its own column, assignees, due date and comments. The subtask shows **Subtask of** at the top — tap that to come back up.
- The unlink icon separates the two cards again. **It does not delete anything** — the subtask stays on the board as an ordinary card.
- A parent card shows a small **N subtasks** marker on the board, so you can tell at a glance that it breaks down further.

A subtask is a real card, not a checklist item: it moves through columns, gets assigned, and can be discussed like anything else. A card can be a subtask of only one other card, and both must be on the same board.

Sharing a card

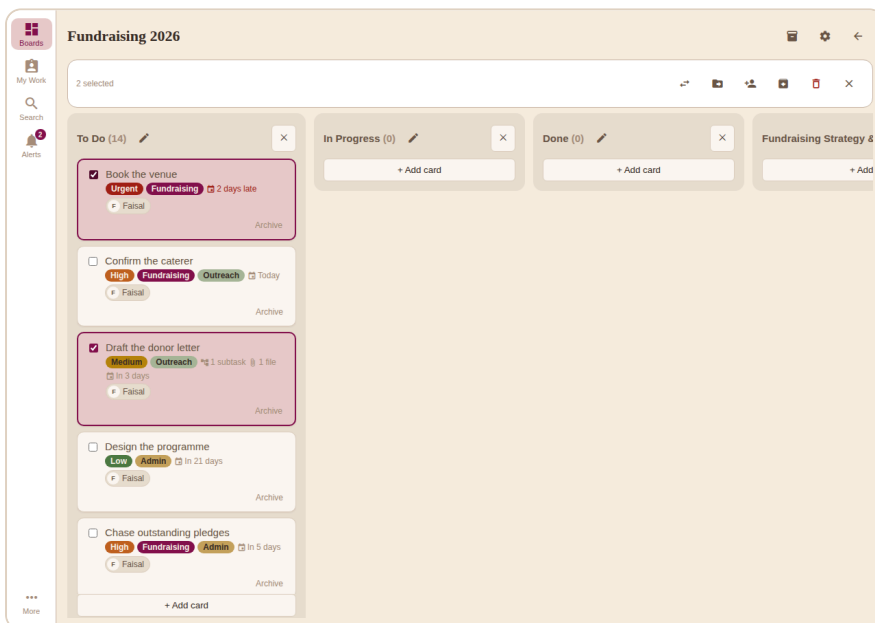
The top of every card shows **which board it's on** — tap it to jump straight to that board. Beside the back arrow is a **Share** button. It hands the card's link to your phone's share sheet — WhatsApp, Google Chat, a text, whatever you use — or, on a computer, copies the link to paste anywhere.

Whoever opens the link lands directly on that card, as long as they're signed in and a member of its board. If they aren't a member, or the card has been deleted, the link says so instead of opening a blank screen.

Moving cards

In a browser, drag a card between columns. **On a phone**, long-press the card and pick the destination column — dragging isn't used on a screen that already swipes between columns, where a drag would be ambiguous.

1.6 Doing several cards at once



In a browser — tick the boxes



On a phone — long-press, then tap

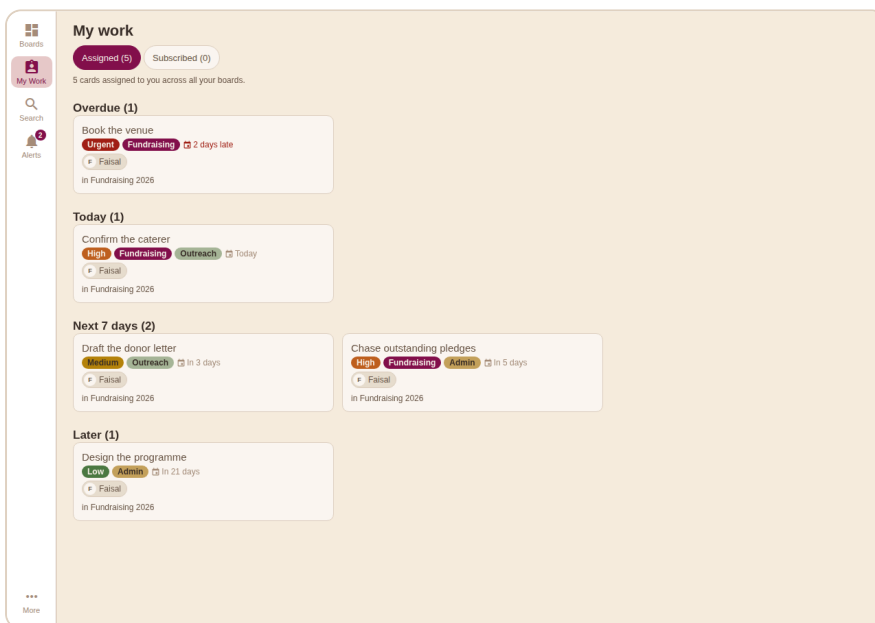
Select several cards — **tick the boxes** in a browser (hold **Shift** for a range), or **long-press** one on a phone and then tap the rest. A bar appears with what you can do to the whole selection: **move**, **assign**, **archive**, or (managers) **delete**.

You can also **copy or move the selection to another board** — pick one of your boards, then a column in it.

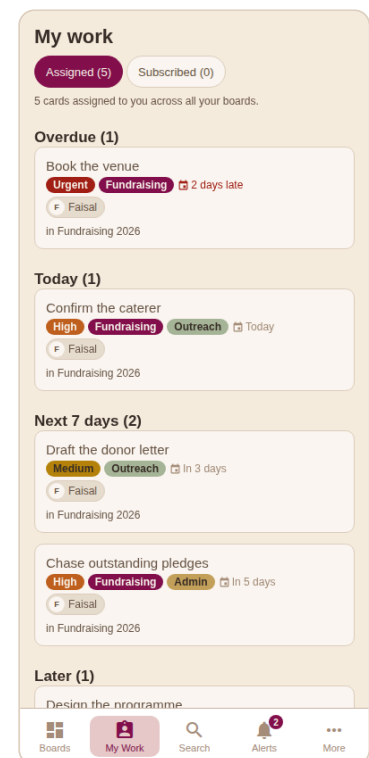
- A **move** takes each card over exactly as it is: comments, history and attached files all travel with it, because it stays the same card.
- A **copy** leaves the originals alone and starts **fresh** cards — same title, description, priority, due date and labels, but **no comments, no history and no files**. A copy is new work, not a second pointer at the same work.

Labels come with both, since they are shared by every board and mean the same thing wherever a card lands. Anyone **not a member of the destination board is unassigned**, though; the sheet tells you before you confirm.

1.7 My Work



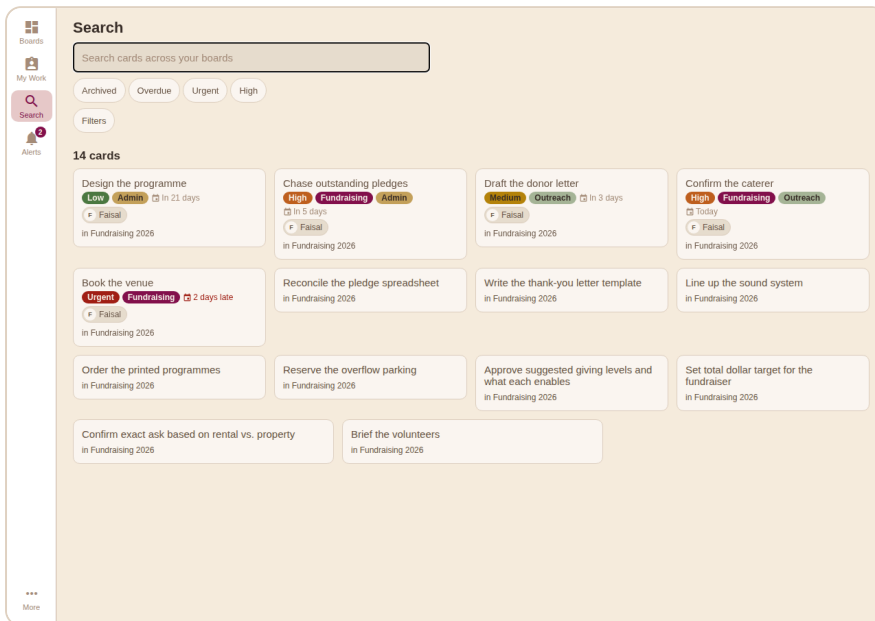
In a browser



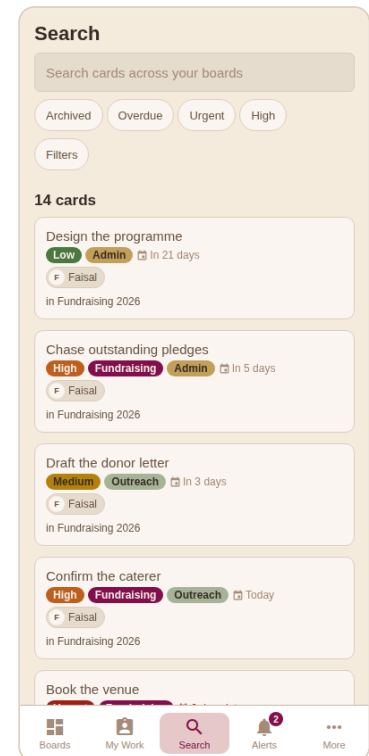
On a phone

Everything assigned to you, across every board, grouped by urgency: **overdue** first, then **today**, then the **next seven days**, then everything else. This is the fastest way to see what needs you — especially on a phone. Tap any card to open it.

1.8 Search



In a browser



On a phone

Search lists **every card on every board you're on**, newest first — you don't have to type anything, and **the keyboard stays shut** until you tap the box, so you can browse and filter without it covering half the results. Typing narrows by title and description; it matches whole words and parts of words, but not misspellings.

Above the results are **filter chips**. The first row is one tap each:

- **Archived** — shows **only** archived cards, and hides the live ones. This is the other way to find something you archived, alongside a board's own archive.
- **Overdue** — only cards past their due date.
- **Urgent / High** — only cards at that priority.

The second row starts with **Filters**, which opens a panel holding the two filters that are *lists* rather than switches:

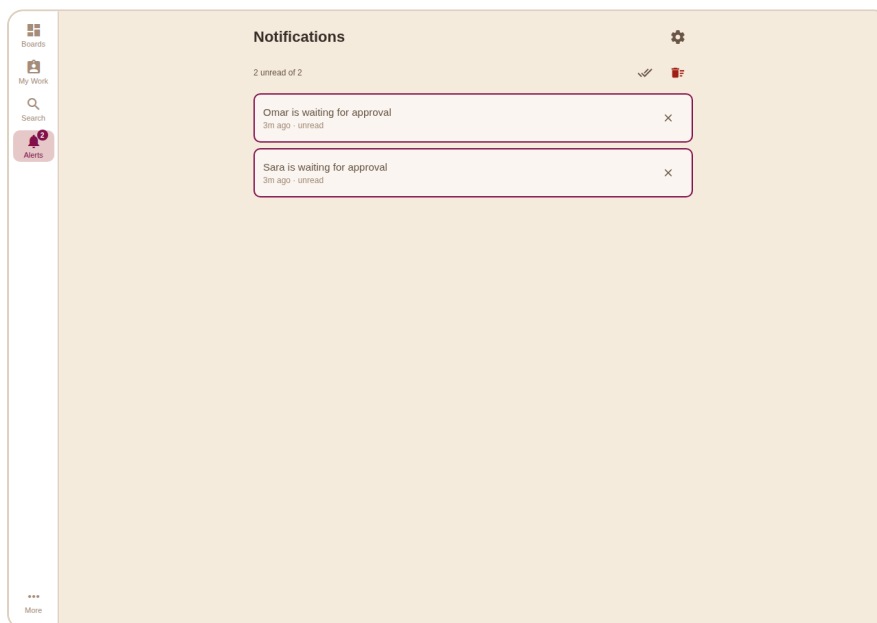
- **Board** — narrow to a single board.
- **Label** — pick one or several; you get cards carrying **any** of them.

Whatever you pick comes back as **its own chip** in that second row, so the answer to “what am I filtering by?” is always one row you can read at a glance — and tapping a chip removes that filter, the same gesture as everything else. When anything is active, a **clear-filters** icon appears at the end of the row and switches everything off at once. It is only there when there is something to clear.

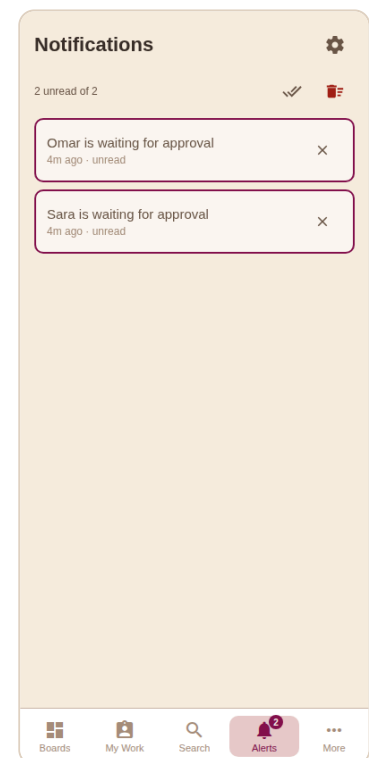
Your search survives leaving it. Open a result, then come back, and the text, the chips and the board and label picks are all as you left them — you don’t have to rebuild a search to look at a second card. Filters reset when the app is reloaded, because a filter you set last week isn’t one you meant to still be looking through today.

If there are more results than fit on screen the app says so, rather than quietly cutting the list short. Tap a result to open the card.

1.9 Notifications



In a browser



On a phone

Alerts shows everything you've been told about, so nothing is lost if a phone notification is missed or swiped away. You're alerted when a card is **assigned** to you, when someone **@mentions** you in a comment, and — for admins — when a **new account** is waiting. Unread items are outlined; tap one to go straight to what it is about — the card for a card alert, **People** for an account waiting for approval. Tapping the notification on your phone's lock screen or in its notification tray does the same thing, including when the app was not running.

Each item has a **✕** to dismiss it. At the top of the list, **✓✓** marks everything read and the **sweep** icon empties the inbox — that one asks first, because dismissed alerts cannot be brought back.

Alerts keeps the last **90 days** and clears out anything older on its own, so the list stays worth reading. Nothing is lost by it — a card keeps its own comments and activity permanently.

The **gear** opens notification settings, where each kind of notification has an on/off switch and you can **mute** individual boards with the bell. One kind is off by default — “a card assigned to you was moved” — because on a busy board it fires constantly. **You are never notified about your own actions.**

The app asks for notification permission when you sign in — allow it on each device where you want push notifications. Notifications follow the account signed in on the device.

1.10 Signing out

More → Sign out (in the navigation bar). Signing out clears your session on this phone or browser and stops it receiving that account's notifications. The next sign-in shows Google's account chooser, which is how you switch accounts.

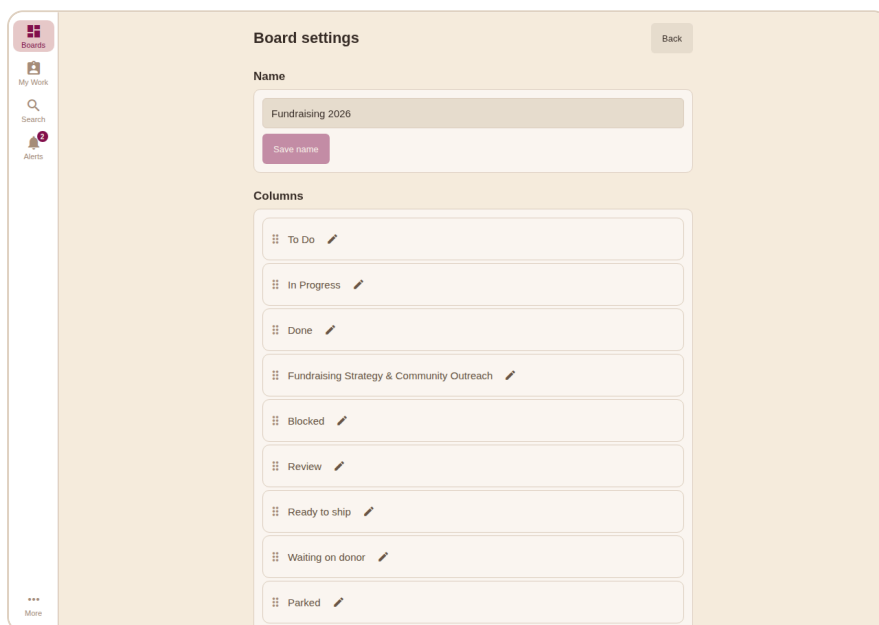
Part 2 — For managers

Managers can see and join **every** board, create new ones, and shape a board's columns and membership. They also curate the org-wide **labels** — anyone may add one, but only managers rename or delete. There are no per-board roles: a manager can act on any board.

2.1 Creating a board

On **Boards**, tap **New board** and give it a name. Every new board starts with three columns — **To Do**, **In Progress**, **Done** — which you can rename or replace in Settings.

2.2 Board settings



In a browser



On a phone

Open a board and tap its **settings** (the gear). From here:

- **Columns** — add, rename, and reorder. Tap the **pencil** beside a column's name to rename it; drag the handle to reorder. A column can only be deleted once it's **empty**, so no cards vanish with it, and deleting one **asks first** because it cannot be undone. To clear a column quickly, select its cards and move or archive them in one go.

- **Labels** — one vocabulary shared by **every board**, not just this one. Adding, renaming or deleting a label here changes it everywhere, and the panel says so. Use the **pencil** to rename, the **palette** to cycle its colour, and the **bin** to delete — deleting asks first and tells you how many cards carry it, because it comes off all of them.

Colours come from a fixed palette so they stay readable on the app's warm surfaces. Names are short by design, and two labels can't share a name even in different capitals — a card face shows the name and nothing else, so "Urgent" and "urgent" would be impossible to tell apart.

Anyone can add a label, not just managers: open any card and press **+** beside its labels. It joins the shared set and is applied to that card at the same time. Only managers rename or delete. -

Members — who can see the board. Tap the **add-person** icon beside the *Members* heading to see who else can be added, and tap a name to add them. Removing someone (the **remove-person** icon on their row) also **unassigns them from that board's cards**; you're told how many before it happens. Your **own** row shows a **leave** icon instead — use it to step off a board you no longer work. - **Archive** — hides the board from everyone's list. Boards are never deleted outright.

Renaming a column without opening Settings. Column names are editable from the board itself too — tap the **pencil** beside the column name (on a phone, in the column header at the top; on a wide screen, at the top of each column). Only managers and admins see it; everyone else just sees the name.

Joining or leaving a board yourself. Because managers and admins can open **any** board's settings, a board you haven't joined shows a **Join this board** button at the top of **Members**. Joining makes you assignable to its cards and lists the board under your own boards; **Leave** reverses both. Only your *own* membership is self-service — everyone else is added and removed by a manager or admin.

2.3 Archiving a board

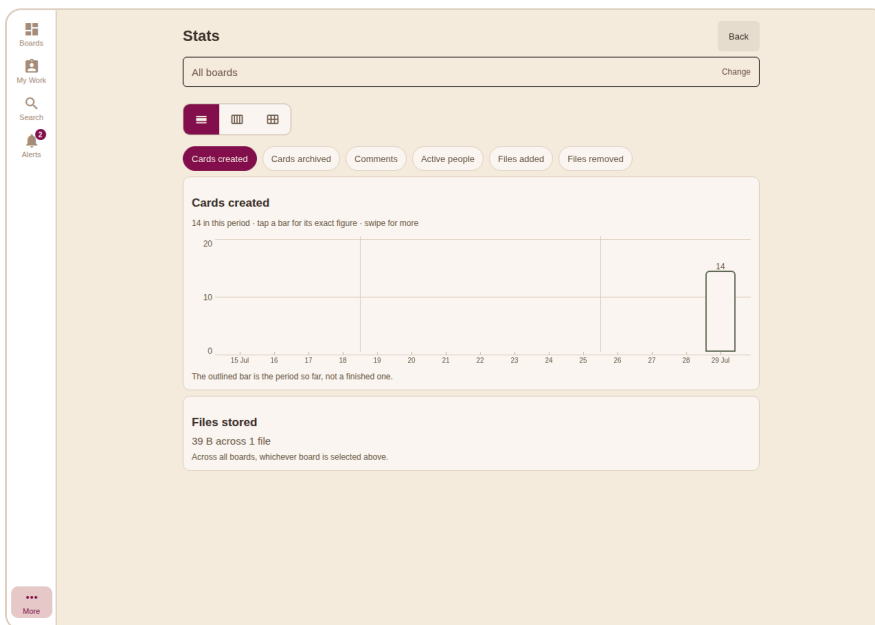
Boards **archive**, they don't get hard-deleted, so nothing is lost by accident. Managers and admins see an **Archived** section at the bottom of the board list — open one from there and use **Restore** in its settings to bring it back. It stays collapsed unless something is actually archived.

Archiving a board **puts its work away too**: its cards drop out of everyone's **My Work** and **Search**, and it stops sending notifications and due-date reminders. Nothing is deleted — restore the board and all of it comes straight back, exactly as it was.

2.4 Deleting cards

Members archive cards; **managers and admins can delete** them permanently. Archiving keeps a card out of the way but recoverable; deletion is final and takes its comments and history with it. When in doubt, archive.

2.5 Stats — how the boards are being used



In a browser



On a phone

More → Stats. Managers and admins only. It answers “is this being used, and by whom?” — nothing about individual performance, and nothing you can drill into a person with.

Three controls sit above the chart:

- **The board** — one board, or **All boards**. Archived boards stay in the list and are marked, because archiving a board doesn't retract the work that happened on it.

- **Daily / Weekly / Monthly** — the three calendar icons. Weeks run **Sunday to Saturday** and months are real calendar months, not rolling windows, so a week here is the week everyone means.
- **What to measure** — cards created, cards archived, comments, **active people**, files added, files removed.

Active people counts how many *different* people did something that day — not who signed in. Opening the app changes nothing; creating a card, commenting or attaching a file does.

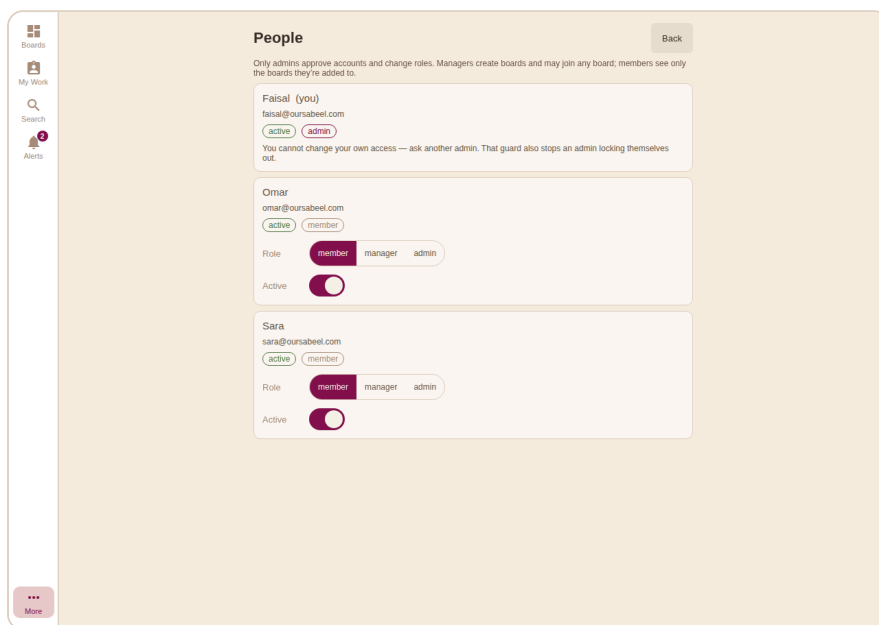
The chart scrolls sideways when there are more bars than fit; **tap a bar** for its exact figure and date. The **last bar is outlined rather than filled** because today isn't finished yet — a half-day next to whole ones would read as a decline that hasn't happened. Below it, **Files stored** gives the total size held across all attachments.

History goes back **twelve months** and is kept indefinitely. Figures for past days are counted once and stored, so the screen opens instantly however much history there is; only the current day is worked out live.

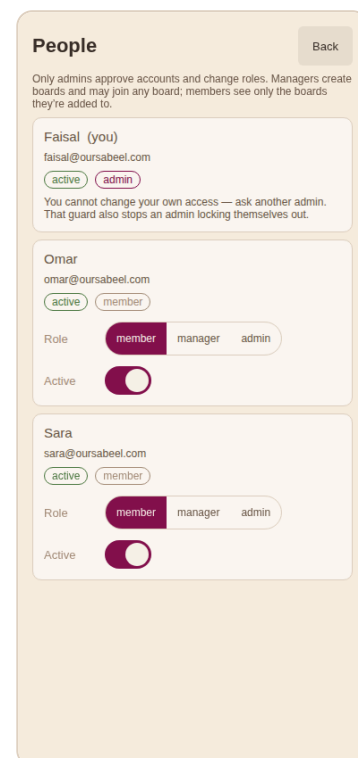
Part 3 — For admins

Admins manage **people**. Everything a manager can do, an admin can do too — plus approve accounts and change roles.

3.1 The People screen — approving new users



In a browser



On a phone

Open **More** → **People**. It lists everyone who has signed in. A new account waits on **pending** and sees nothing until you approve it — approve it here and their screen unlocks live, wherever they are. Admins also get a push notification when someone is waiting.

3.2 Managing a user

Each person's role and access are shown as **controls set to their current value** — a **role** (member / manager / admin) and an **Active** toggle — rather than buttons you press. You change someone by moving the control to where you want it:

- **Member** — sees only the boards they've been added to.
- **Manager** — can see and join every board, create boards, edit columns/labels/ membership, and delete cards.

- **Admin** — everything a manager can, plus approve accounts and change roles.
- **Active** — turn off to **disable** an account. Whatever they have open switches to an “Account disabled” screen straight away, wherever they are, and they cannot sign back in. **Their card assignments are kept** so nothing is left ownerless — a manager can reassign at leisure. Turn back on to restore. Nothing is ever deleted.

Every change asks you to **confirm**, spelling out what it will actually let that person do, so a stray tap can’t promote or lock out anyone. You **cannot change your own access** — that’s what stops an admin locking themselves out.

Part 4 — “How do I...?” quick answers

...get in for the first time? Sign in with your @oursabeel.com Google account, then wait on the approval screen until an admin lets you in (it updates by itself).

...add a card? Open the board → + **Add card** at the foot of a column → type a title → Enter.

...change a card’s priority, due date, or assignees? Open the card → tap a priority / due date / **Assign someone** → choose.

...move a card to another column? In a browser, drag it. On a phone, long-press it and pick the column — or open the card and change the **column** dropdown.

...move or copy cards to a different board? Select them (tick boxes, or long-press on a phone) → **move/copy to another board** → pick the board and column.

...find a card I can’t see? **Search** (its words), or **My Work** if it’s assigned to you.

...share a card with a colleague? Open the card → **Share** → send the link. They open it and land on the card (if they’re a member of its board).

...see everything assigned to me? **My Work** — grouped overdue → today → next seven days.

...stop a noisy notification? **Alerts** → **Settings** → switch off that kind, or **mute** the board.

...create a board? (*managers*) **Boards** → **New board** → name it.

...rename or add columns? (*managers*) Open the board → **settings** → Columns.

...add a label? (*anyone*) Open any card → + beside its labels. Labels are shared by every board, so it appears everywhere at once.

...rename or delete a label? (*managers*) Open any board → **settings** → **Labels**. Deleting removes it from every card that carries it, and tells you how many first — counting live cards and archived ones separately, because a card in the archive is one no board will show you.

...follow a card that isn’t mine? Open it → the **bell** in the header. It appears under **My work** → **Subscribed**, and you’ll hear about new comments.

...find every card with a particular label? **Search** → **Filters** → **Label**, and pick one. Pick more than one and you get cards carrying **any** of them. Each pick becomes a chip; tap it to drop it.

...search within one board only? **Search** → **Filters** → **Board**. It becomes a chip like everything else — tap the chip to go back to searching everywhere.

...clear every filter at once? The **clear-filters** icon at the end of the chip row. It only appears when something is actually filtering.

...see how much the boards are being used? (*managers/admins*) **More** → **Stats** — cards created and archived, comments, how many different people were active, and files, by day, week or month.

...add someone to a board? (*managers*) Board **settings** → **Members** → add them. (They must be an approved account first.)

...delete a card? (*managers/admins*) Open the card → delete. Members **archive** instead.

...let a new team member in? (*admins*) They sign in once with Google → **More** → **People** → **Approve** their pending card.

...make someone a manager or admin? (*admins*) **People** → their card → set the **role** → confirm the dialog.

...disable someone who left? (*admins*) **People** → their card → **Active** off → confirm. Their assignments and history stay.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What it means	What to do
“Waiting for approval” after signing in	Your account awaits admin approval	Ask your admin; the screen unlocks by itself once approved
You can’t sign in at all	Only @oursabeel.com Google accounts are allowed	Use your work account, not a personal one
A card’s due date is red	The card is overdue	Open it and update the date, or get the work done
“This card is unavailable” from a shared link	You’re not a member of its board, or the card was deleted	Ask a manager to add you to the board
A column won’t delete	It still has cards in it	Move or archive its cards first, then delete the column
Removing a board member warns about cards	They’re assigned to cards on that board	Those cards are unassigned automatically; the warning just says how many
No push notifications arriving	Permission not granted on this device, or that kind is muted	Allow notifications when the app asks, and check Alerts → Settings
A red “Live data error” bar	The app couldn’t reach the server or was refused	It clears when the connection recovers; if it persists, tell Faisal what the bar says

Manual source: `docs/USER-MANUAL.md`. Its images live in `docs/manual/img/` and are regenerated from the seeded dev stack by `node scripts/manual-shots.mjs` (every one except `pending.png`, which needs an unapproved account). The PDF is built from the markdown by `python3 docs/render-manual.py`. When the app changes, update all three in the same batch — text, images, PDF.